infected individuals and reducing the transmission of malaria.

The control measures include the use of insecticides such as DDT (Di chlorodiphenyl tri chloromethane) or Malathion for controlling the populations of adult mosquitoes.

Proper use of mosquito nets, wearing protective clothings and use of mosquito repellants can prevent the mosquito bite.

Introduction to Helminths

General characteristics of Helminthic parasite:

1. Helminths are multicellular worms. They are bilaterally symmetrical animals having 3 germ layers and belong to the kingdom Metazoa.
2. They are invertebrates characterised by elongated, flat or round bodies.
3. Helminths develop through egg, larval and adult stages. Flowchart 8.1 describes the classification of helminthes.

8.6 Nematode: *Ascaris Lumbricoides*

8.6.1 Geographical Distribution

It is the most common of human helminthes and is distributed worldwide.

8.6.2 Habitat

The adult worms lives in the small intestine particularly in jejunum and in ileum.

8.6.3 Morphology

Adult worm

Ascaris lumbricoides resembles and sometimes confused with the earthworm. Its specific name *lumbricoides* means earthworm in Latin. Male and Female worm of Ascaris lumbricoides are shown in Figure 8.15.



Figure 8.15: Adult worms of *Ascaris Lumbricoides*

- They are large cylindrical worms with tapering ends. The anterior end being thinner than the posterior end. It is the largest intestinal nematode parasitizing man.
- The life – span of the adult worm is less than a year.

Male worm

- The adult male worm is smaller than female worms.

DO YOU KNOW?

The roundworm, Ascaris lumbricoides is the largest nematode parasite in the human intestine. An editorial in the lancet in 1989 observed. That if all the round worms in all people worldwide were placed end-to-end. They would encircle the world 50 times. Soil-transmitted intestinal nematodes are called Geohelminths.

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